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Entrepreneurship 3100

Professor Gulick

8 May 2026

Brand-Inna-Box

I. Business Description

[Original]

Our idea started with this issue: small businesses and local shops know they need to post on social media, but their content looks cheap or inconsistent because they lack a designer. However, then we realized we were too vague and not enticing enough for our customer base, so we decided to pivot. We are in Ames, known for its many food trucks, yet no one really knows where they will be, and there are very few repeat customers. So, if we market to food trucks, we will have a large yet niche customer base that also needs marketing, since they have very few returning customers.

In the customer's mind, cheap-looking media equals cheap, not great, services/products. Most food trucks have an interesting design to draw people in, but essentially zero marketing. By using social media, we can develop their brand image, let people know where they are going, and drastically increase their customer return rate. This was how Brand-Inna-Box was born. We offer premium marketing services that help local food trucks market effectively, enabling them to build returning customers and a strong brand image.

Our first product is the Premium Brand Kit. This includes a meet-up with our professionals to create brand image (fonts, colors, templates), custom buyer personas, and market audience. This is our initial buy-in to our company. The next product is a subscription service called the Marketing Aid Kit, where small businesses send in their photos and videos, and our professionals use their premium brand kit to brand, caption, and post their content onto their social media. This is our main product.

II. Competitive Landscape

Who else is solving this problem today? For each major competitor or alternative, briefly describe how they work, what they charge, and where they fall short for your target customer. Then explain how your business compares — where you are stronger, where you are weaker, and what that means for how you position and price. This section should directly inform your value proposition and revenue sections. If it does not connect to those sections, you have not gone deep enough here.

Some of the other businesses competing in the small-business marketing landscape include NinjaPromo, Firebelly Marketing, Fresh Content Society, SociallyIn, Spin Brands, and Cool Nerds Marketing. All these companies are like ours in that they offer subscriptions or monthly retainers for their clients in exchange for mostly social media marketing services. Most of our competitors are also full-service agencies, meaning they handle nearly all the customer's marketing needs, eliminating the need for the customer to find multiple specialists. All our competitors listed participate in social media strategy and management, content creation, paid social advertising, influencer marketing, and analytics and performance tracking. What separates

us is our specific beachhead of primarily marketing for food trucks. Since Ames and Des Moines are major hubs for food trucks, there is a market there, especially since these trucks rarely bring in repeat customers. If we market these trucks online, we can raise awareness of where they are and where they will be, the menu, and other details a consumer may want to know. By bringing this info directly to customers' phones through our online social media campaign, we can greatly increase the rate at which food trucks gain consistent returning customers.

NinjaPromo is a small-business marketing agency offering a broad range of services. The first service they offer that is unique compared to the other companies we will list is their participation in search engine optimization (SEO) and pay-per-click advertising (PPC). SEO services involve using specific keywords across marketing activities to help a company appear in more search results. Next is PPC, which involves bidding on keywords people may search for related to a company, so your ad shows up when those keywords are searched. Along with SEO and PPC, NinjaPromo also helps its clients create landing pages and websites that appear in search results. Next, NinjaPromo helps its clients with email marketing and creates a tailored overall marketing strategy for each client. NinjaPromo's pricing strategy involves customers paying for a set number of hours of services each month, with costs ranging from \$80 to \$100 per hour, depending on the plan they choose.

The next of our main competitors is Firebelly Marketing. The main aspect that sets Firebelly apart from its competitors is its specialization in growing customer followings on social media. One way they do this is through influencer marketing. They seek out many small content creators who make testimonials for their customers' products and post them on social media. Next, Firebelly allows customers to purchase email and text message marketing services from

them at an additional cost. Firebelly Marketing offers monthly retainers ranging from \$1K to \$10K, with the average customer paying \$3K to \$10 K.

The last of our competitors is Spin Brands, which is most similar to our company in its core business. They focus primarily on developing creative campaigns for their customers, using social media and staying current with trends. Spin Brands also specializes in developing new brands, maintaining consistent branding, and giving them a voice. Spin Brands offers both monthly retainers and hourly rates for its services. They charge an average of \$100-\$149 an hour, and their retainers range from \$550-\$5K for smaller clients. Spin Brands also offers specific projects, but pricing starts at \$ 10 K.

One area where our competitors fall short is their approach to building trust with smaller businesses. We understand that securing business with smaller, younger companies may require significant effort, as we found in our interviews. However, it is much easier to get a younger company to trust us rather than an older established one. In Luke Harrison's interview, he explains how hard it is for a customer to hand over some of the operations of their business that they have worked so hard to get started. We would send representatives to meet with our customers in person or deliver via virtual calls to understand their concerns and learn how we can provide satisfactory marketing results. One thing we are really focusing on is being trustworthy and quick to respond to customer needs. We will need to manage the number of clients we take on at a time, so we are not too busy to meet with them whenever needed. We would also work with our customers to display data about the impact of our services. Where our main competitors fall short is that they do not provide key analytical metrics to their customers; they only share social media results. We would gather data on the number of leads, customers, and revenue generated by our services.

Finally, an area where we may be weaker than some of these other companies is our size. We do not have a huge team to take on a ton of large projects all at once. We also do not yet have the size or popularity to find popular content creators to advertise for either ourselves or our customers, if that is the kind of marketing they want.

Due to our shortcomings and the unmet customer needs our competitors do not address, we are going to set the entry point for our services at \$300-\$1,000 per month and not subject our clients to any long contracts. This way, we can acquire customers more easily, deliver results that keep them coming back to us for our services, and build our reputation with them. This will allow us to secure long-term contracts in the future. We also have a more defined target audience than our competitors. We are mainly looking to market food trucks early on, as this is an untapped market in our local area (Ames and Des Moines). This will make us the only real player in the market while also being affordable.

III. Customer Segments

[Original]

Our main target markets are small business owners, people looking to become influencers, and clubs. Many small businesses struggle with gaining traction because they have a hard time getting the word out. This can be remedied with Brand in a Box and our social media marketing expertise. These small businesses do not have the funds for traditional large-scale marketing. Still, Brand in a Box specializes in using social media, which is cheap and offers the largest possible reach of any marketing channel. Our cost-efficient strategy means struggling

businesses can use our services and still have a very large reach, with customers now made aware of the business.

Being an influencer is the most sought-after job by Gen Z and Gen alpha so the market is very large. Most people cannot get their name out there, so their careers die before they even start. Fortunately, Brand in a Box specializes in social media marketing, so we can help them learn the skills needed to become famous online. We will be able to sell our services to build up new influencers.

The final part of our key market is clubs and groups. At Iowa State, there are over 100 clubs and groups that we can easily access. We will help market these clubs and groups to help them expand their membership. Once we expand the business beyond Ames, we can help many clubs and groups throughout the state and maybe even the country.

[Updated] How did your interviews confirm, refine, or rule out each segment? What did people from each group say about their likelihood to buy or use? Did you discover any new segments you had not considered, and if so, who and why do they matter? How many people from each segment did you interview? Which segment are you choosing as your beachhead market, and why that one over the others?

We are narrowing our target market from small business owners, people trying to become influencers, and clubs to startups in their first 3 years of operation that are super-focused on creating their product or service and do not have time to maintain marketing. We would use food trucks in and around the Ames area as our beachhead market before expanding into other areas, such as startups, pop-up shops, and possibly gameday vendors at Jack Trice Stadium.

From our interviews, we learned that establishing trust with our prospective clients could be harder than we initially thought, which is why we are choosing to target companies in their first 3 years of operation. Companies that are older than this- even small businesses- are more likely to have an effective method for keeping up with marketing, which means we have less perceived value to offer them. This was one of the takeaways from interviewing Amy Tharp from Pix Along the Way, a photography company in eastern Iowa that has been around for over a decade. Amy explained that she handles all the business's social media and marketing and regularly posts a lot of advertising content, even though the business has only two owners and no employees.

For other companies that are roughly the same age, such as UniMovers- a moving company that was founded in 2017- it is beneficial to hire marketing help. This is what Jack Norby discovered in his interview with the Owner of UniMovers Des Moines.

One attribute of social media marketing is that many people are posting to the same audience because of how algorithms work. This is what Jack Norby discovered when he interviewed Ryder Hermann. This makes it hard to reach new people. Amy Tharp with Pix Along the Way explained that much of the value in marketing is getting the product in front of people to remind those who are already interested to act and make a purchase, so sometimes you do want to market to the same people.

One thing Luke learned from his interviews was that companies that are not as well-established are more likely to trust someone to handle their marketing than those that are more well-established. This is consistent with what we saw in the other interviews.

After compiling all this, it is determined that the most critical aspect of our customer segmentation strategy is our strong focus on young businesses (in their first 3 years of operation). This is not narrow enough in scope, however. We cannot focus on all young businesses, so we must choose another segment that overlaps with them.

Geographically, we are focusing on businesses local to Ames because it is familiar to the team, and we are more likely to know people, which means word-of-mouth advertising about our company is much more effective here than if we were to move to a new location.

The specific industry we are targeting our beach head is food trucks, because we have first-hand evidence from reviewing food truck websites and social media pages that the industry benefits from social media marketing. As an example, Carlos Quesadillas' food truck in Ames, IA, has a strong social media presence. In summary, we are targeting food trucks and pop-up stores in their first three years of operation in the Ames area.

IV. Value Proposition

One of our group members has experience with similar marketing packages that we would be providing to our customers. In one of his interviews with a customer, he said, "Dylan said he would spend up to an hour on each post, losing out on a lot of time he needed to focus elsewhere as a busy business owner. After I started working for Dylan, he reported that it saves him a ton of time that he can put towards "doing moves, answering the phone, booking movers, and finding time to work on the company itself." In another interview, Colby asked Truman Kruckenberg about the value of marketing for him. Truman runs a lawn mowing and landscaping company during the summer, but found that our value proposition may not apply to those in

similar positions. “Truman said he could see a benefit to marketing via social media. However, he feels that most of his customers are those who would not find him on social media.” While this is a valid concern, lawn mowing and food trucks are completely different games when it comes to social media and marketing. Lawn care relies heavily on word of mouth and does not need as strong a social media presence as food trucks. Food trucks, on the other hand, will struggle a lot if they rely solely on word of mouth. Food trucks are constantly moving between places and cities and need a way to communicate with all their loyal customers while also getting the word out to new customers. Social media gives a perfect opportunity to do both of those things. Based on both interviews, it is very important to recognize the differences between businesses and the value we can provide to each. In reflecting on his interviews, Justin Johnson said, “From interviewing the marketer for the horticulture club and the marketer for Minnesota state Phi Delta Theta, I learned that even organizations (not just businesses) struggle with maintaining a consistent and professional social media presence. Both emphasized that, while they understand the importance of branding and engagement, their content often ends up inconsistent, rushed, or lacking a cohesive identity due to limited time, changing team members, and a lack of formal design experience. They also noted that social media plays a major role in recruitment, event promotion, and overall perception, meaning poor quality posts can directly impact interest.” This is the value we wish to provide: time-saving for our customers and a stronger brand image and perception among their own customers in their small businesses.

V. Channels

[Original]

Our customers will contact us, and we will send a representative to meet with them for a sit-down conversation. In the conversation, we will discuss various marketing plans and their associated prices. Once a deal is reached, we will begin marketing as planned and leave the representative's number with the client in case they have any questions, concerns, or alterations they intend to make. From there, the communication is only as consistent as the customer wants it to be.

[Updated]

Our interviews only confirmed that using social media as our delivery and marketing channels is one of the best options for our business. Social media marketing for our own business and for our customers is the best way to reach a wide audience. Along with this, we still plan to meet with our customers in person or via Zoom or Microsoft Teams to help put a face to a name and build trust.

When marketing our own business, we would follow many of the practices we plan to use for our clients. Our overall marketing plan would be to advertise on social media, primarily TikTok and Instagram, and post funny, interesting videos to break out of the "content bubble" and reach a wide audience. This is not necessarily what we would be doing for our own clients, but a post or two going viral would build our credibility and show that we can generate strong outreach for our clients through our subscription service. Another plan for our marketing would be to keep consistent branding and brand image. In addition, we would also pay to appear in Google search results, as many of our competitors do. Finally, we will also rely on word of mouth to grow our business. Many business owners rely on recommendations from peers when running their own businesses, and we anticipate getting our name into that mix.

When marketing to our beachhead, food trucks in Ames, we would start by talking to food trucks in person, particularly after busy events, because that is when the owners are most likely to be there. Then we could pitch our business to them and either set up a meeting or leave them with a business card with a link to a website showcasing our previous work, using Jack Norby's work as our first example.

Based on our interviews, a food truck would likely be interested in our services because it may not have an established brand or a consistent social media presence. They are also most likely young companies since food trucks typically have a short lifespan. The younger and less experienced with social media, the better, because we found in our interviews that people who have never done their own social media posts or branding are more likely to pay someone else to do it. On top of this, if they are inconsistent or have a limited social media presence, they might be neglecting it because they see it as a hassle and do not understand the impact of effective marketing on their business. These are some of the reasons why businesses have poor marketing, as we discovered in our interviews. This is why we would show them examples and numbers of our work. If they see marketing as too much of a hassle, that is the perfect opportunity for us to convince them to let us handle it.

VI. Customer Relationships

[Updated]

Our relationship with customers is based on a contract. We will launch a marketing campaign on the scale specified in the contract, and the extent of our campaign will be tied to the extent of our compensation. Even though our direct communication with our customer base

(local food trucks in the Ames area) will be very professional, our marketing will be very lighthearted.

During the team's interviews, particularly with Jack Kopilash, we really took note of how we would engage with the public. This was particularly evident during the interview with Ryder Hermann, the social media chair of Phi Kappa Theta, when he said, "Whenever I post to the Phi Kappa Instagram, it is always the same 50 people liking every single post. Sometimes I do not even feel like a marketing chair because I am never able to broaden our audience in any meaningful way." Every social media platform pushes content that causes the greatest chance for each user to engage with. This means that everyone has a "content bubble" or a hyper individualized for you page that makes it hard for posts to reach the view of anyone who does not already engage with a particular page. Due to the content bubble phenomenon, to expand our influence beyond our follower base, we need to create shareable content. For this to happen, we need to advertise in a way that is funny, relatable, and unique, so it is noteworthy enough for people to share with their friends.

An example of this would be any of Nutter Butter's official pages. They produce weird, visually unique, horror-influenced posts to get people talking about them. Their most-viewed TikTok had 21.7 million views, and their average TikTok post gets about 100,000. This type of marketing is different, but the results are evident. Nutter Butter is one of the few brands whose ads people watch willingly because they offer something interesting to see. This is the type of content we need to make for the public to see.

This marketing works well for Nutter Butter and, if implemented correctly, could work for us and our businesses. Since we are targeting food trucks, it may take a combination of content ideas to make something work. If we focus on content like Nutter Butter, we will likely

confuse our clients initially. By taking Nutter Butter's approach, such as making weird and wacky posts and combining it with a hook, such as the dates and times where the food truck would be, could yield some successful posts. Recently, a lot of posts have gone viral where businesses or organizations use something weird or wacky to get customers to stop scrolling and, at the end of the video, add details about their product, service, or event. By using this clickbait style while also posting content that explains and maintains the business's stable brand image, we could master the art of going viral without losing the business's original image, which would yield the most success.

VII. Key Resources

[Original]

We identified a couple of resources when we first came up with the idea—first, the people to meet with the business that had training in social media marketing. Without these people, our idea would not be able to function. These marketing specialists would allow us to deliver the professional, polished work they need. Another key resource we identified was the hardware and software needed to run Brand-In-a-Box. First, we use Adobe Photoshop to deliver professional-looking posts for our business owners. The next would be Buffer. It allows us to schedule and post to multiple social media platforms at once. Buffer would be the hub of most of the work we do. It would allow us to easily schedule and track all the posts we send for the businesses that need our help. These are the key resources we initially identified to keep Brand-In-a-Box running smoothly.

[Updated]

The interviews helped us in a couple of ways. They helped us see that the key resources we identified before remain at the hub of our business and are not going anywhere. The software aspect will not change at all. The marketing professionals are still needed, but could be outsourced to AI. There are many ways to customize chatbots to better fit your needs. A custom AI chatbot could be a good option for outsourcing marketing, especially when the business takes off and there is not enough money to hire marketing professionals. Another key resource identified by the interviews was a portfolio of the work we have done for businesses to build customer trust. This is essential to find a way to prove to the customers that we are worth buying from. A portfolio showing previous work would be needed to build that trust. The last key resource we identified was the ability to market on Google and ChatGPT. Many marketing leads come from internet searches, especially AI searches. The company targets these leads using Buffer, as mentioned in the previous section. We were not far off to start, but the interviews helped us identify key resources we had not seen before.

VIII. Key Activities

[Original]

Obtaining and maintaining strong and long-term relationships with companies and clubs. This will ensure a steady revenue stream and returning customers. By building strong relationships with returning customers, we are more likely to have them recommend us to others and bring in more customers. Also, by working with successful companies, others will see their success and advertisements and want to follow what they have, leading others to be drawn towards our company.

[Updated]

The key activities of our company are the fundamental tasks we need to accomplish regularly for it to function. We must post social media content across various platforms and do so in a way that generates traffic to the target markets of our client companies. We learned from our interviews that generating this outreach may require a guerrilla approach. From Jack Kopilash's interview, we discovered that we may need to create unique content that is entertaining, interesting, or funny to break out of the "content bubble" some businesses perceive themselves to be in. We also must have a thorough understanding of what each company we are advertising for is trying to accomplish with our services: who their target market is, which aspect of their product they see as worth advertising, and what their overall brand identity is. To understand what companies are looking for, we must meet with each company we serve to learn their marketing needs on an individual basis. Demonstrating that we are passionate about creating content that aligns with the customer's business identity was one of the key findings from Luke Harrison's interviews.

IX. Key Partners

[Original]

Originally, the key partners we identified were limited. It is tough to find partners for the style of business that Brand-In-a-Box is. It would be difficult, but an amazing partnership would be with social media platforms. This type of partnership would instill a lot of trust in our customers by seeing the brands they are trying to post on endorsing our services. Another amazing partnership would be with Buffer, the software that lets us schedule and create social

media posts. This would help with the flow of our business a ton. Outside of that, our customers are really our key partners. They are the people who keep Brand-In-a-Box successful and flowing well. The more customers we can help, the more trust and relevancy our business will gain.

[Updated]

The interviews confirmed that we were in a good spot with identifying our key partners. However, the interviews also revealed other key partners we had not seen before. The biggest key partner we identified would be Google, especially for search results and search engine optimization (SEO). As mentioned above in the key resources section, search engine and AI search results have been emerging as a key aspect of internet marketing. Partnering with Google or a major AI company would help us build even more trust with our customers by demonstrating that Brand-In-a-Box is endorsed by these large tech companies. Partners are crucial to our business, but customer trust is what will help our business take off. If we can strategically position our partnerships to boost our customers' trust, we will do well.

X. Cost Structure

[Original]

Most of our costs would be for initial setup, including software, basic equipment, and initial marketing. After those costs are out of the way and we are all set up, costs will be low apart from labor wages and repair/new equipment needs.

[Updated]

Our major costs include the fixed costs of the hardware used to create marketing packages. These are already sunk, as most have laptops already. We would want at least one Apple Mac Mini, which, according to TechRadar, is the best overall PC for editing. This costs \$600 from Apple (Apple Mac Mini, 2026). With this PC, we will also need a monitor at \$140 (Walmart, 2026). We would then need a quality wireless mouse and keyboard, costing \$50 (Logitech, 2026).

To conclude, we would also use image editing software. We will use Creative PCloud Pro, which costs \$19.99 per month or \$240 per year. Adobe says this about the software: “Access 20+ industry-leading apps, including Photoshop, Illustrator, Premiere, and more, plus responsible AI features from Adobe Firefly. Also available for teachers (Adobe, 2026). There is much positive feedback about this editing software, and a user on the reviewing site BeardedCoffeeMonkey said, “As a whole, Adobe Creative Cloud has been a huge personal as well as professional boon to my creative output. From editing and producing videos to making thumbnail images and channel art, all the way down to making a website to support my business, Adobe products are what I use to produce the best work I can and to express myself creatively and meaningfully (Smith, para. 20).” The software subscription is a variable fixed cost, so that will continue into the years of the business. The team estimates hardware wear-and-tear costs at around \$50 per year. So, our fixed costs include the hardware and software used for editing, totaling \$1080 for the first year. We estimate spending around an hour per advertisement, and our package might include 2 per week. Given this, labor will be around 8 hours per package, resulting in a variable labor cost of \$160 per month. So, our unit cost is around \$160. Additionally, we will spend 2 hours a week marketing for our own business, which would cost us another \$160 a month.

XI. Revenue Streams

[Original]

Our main revenue will come from customer subscriptions. These can be short or long-term, depending on how long they would like to work with us. Another stream is the package with initial marketing to companies.

[Updated]

All our revenue comes from companies (specifically targeting food trucks in the Ames/Des Moines area that are in their first 3 years of operation) who want to use our advertising services. The starting price point is \$300- \$1,000 per company per month. This is based on current industry prices. For example, Firebelly's social media management service starts at 2,000 dollars a month (Firebelly FAQs <https://firebellymarketing.com/faqs/>). The smaller businesses that we are targeting will most likely not have big-company marketing budgets, so our lower price point helps us attract young companies. For large organizations, this lower price might reduce our perceived value, but for our target market, the costs fit perfectly with their budgets and what they would be comfortable spending.

XII. Profitability Analysis

Using the costs and revenue figures from Sections X and XI, calculate your contribution margin per transaction or unit and your break-even point, meaning how many transactions or units are needed to cover fixed costs. Then evaluate the business using the economic model from

class — margins multiplied by volume multiplied by revenue drivers. Close this section by identifying what you could realistically do to improve each element of that model.

It is tricky to determine our contribution margin as we will be offering customizable plans for our customers. Our service pricing ranges from \$300 to \$1000 per month. However, we decided that our average plan will cost \$500, with \$240 in variable costs, leaving a contribution margin of \$260 per unit. We originally estimated our variable costs at \$160 per package, but we will need more employee hours for more expensive packages. On the low end (\$300 price point), our CM per unit would be \$140. From here, we anticipate spending 2 more employee hours (at \$20/hour) for every \$100 increase in our package price, meaning our CM per unit would increase by \$60 for every \$100 increase. Now, using \$260 as our average CM per unit, our only recurring fixed cost would be the \$20 for Adobe Firefly. However, we will incur several costs in our first year of operation, totaling \$ 3,000. This would mean our break-even point would be 11.54 months' worth of packages for our first year. After this initial year, our break-even point would be 7.65 months' worth of packages to cover our marketing costs and equipment depreciation. If we want to eventually cover the yearly cost of office space (\$14,400/year) for our operations, we will need to sell 55.38 months' worth of packages per year at our average CM per unit. Even with renting an office space, we would only need to retain 5 clients for about 11 months or 10 clients for about 5-6 months.

If we plan to provide 60 months' worth of services to multiple customers over the course of a year, we would generate \$15,600 in revenue.

To make our model more efficient, we could improve our content production and reduce hours per client. Next, we could increase our volumes by expanding into other markets that are

similar to ours. Finally, we could improve our revenue drivers by offering more services or by increasing referrals by offering rewards for successful referrals.

XIII. What We Still Do Not Know

[Updated]

During our research and planning for Brand in a Box, we decided to focus on social media marketing because it is cost-effective. As a small business, we do not have much capital to invest, so cutting costs is a priority. The problem with this is that there is a phenomenon known as a “content bubble.” In the article, “Trap of Social Media Algorithms...” (2025) by Jacob Erickson, Bei Yan, and Jingyun Huang, they describe a content bubble as, “In an era of intense partisanship, there is widespread concern that people are self-sorting into separate online communities which are detached from one another.” These content bubbles make it hard to market online because people can only see content within their personal bubble. Puncturing through these content bubbles to market is very tricky and requires intelligent use of social media. To break through content bubbles, you need to create something interesting enough to send to your friends.

Another issue we ran across is that, as a small marketing company, our only customers would be other small businesses. We do not have the funds to launch large marketing campaigns, so we will have to run many small-scale marketing campaigns for the business early on.

https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/20563051231186368?utm_source=chatgpt.com

XIV. Future Growth

After our beachhead, Brand-In-a-Box can expand in many ways. After succeeding with food trucks, we can expand to local food and beverage small businesses and home and professional services, such as moving, lawn mowing, landscaping, window washing, and painting. Companies like this would make the most sense to expand to after working with food trucks. If we see success in marketing food trucks, we can also do well working with local food and beverage small businesses. Brand-In-a-Box was born out of the need for marketing in the home and professional services industries. They need a lot of help with marketing for their business, because many of the owners love managing and working in the business, but not marketing it. We could play a significant role in changing the marketing landscape in that industry. When it comes to new products or product extensions, we believe Brand-In-a-Box could be consolidated into a single, all-encompassing app. Using AI technology, we could turn Brand-In-a-Box into a one-stop shop for social media marketing and posting. By designing an AI chatbot that provides marketing expertise equivalent to a marketing specialist and by giving business owners a place to schedule and post to all their social media platforms, we could provide small businesses of any kind with a resource to level up their marketing. Currently, it takes multiple applications to caption, prepare, schedule, and post media to a business's social media. A product like this could completely change the marketing industry as we know it, and we believe that it is a viable option for us to expand to after the takeoff of Brand-In-a-Box.

XV. Next Steps

[Updated]

The first thing that we are going to do is create an internal structure for our company. Everyone will be given a job title and a set of responsibilities. Then we will all negotiate the terms of our compensation. Then we will need to create the company's social media pages and reach out to many local businesses. We need to get clients as soon as possible to get the company off the ground. Once we get a couple of clients and get to work, we need to reinvest that money into potentially expanding into leasing some office space for our company. Not having a location is ok for the first couple of jobs, but if we want to be seen as a legitimate business, we need office space. Once we have office space, Brand in a Box will essentially be fully ready for operation.

XVI. Realistic Assessment

[Updated]

Our strongest reason to look forward is that we are a young team that has experience. Of our members, three are accounting majors, managing the finances and reports of our young company, and one member (Jack Norby) has interned with a marketing firm in Des Moines. He has seen the inner workings of a professional marketing firm firsthand so that he can model Brand in a Box after that company. Also, as a young team, we are all in Gen Z and have grown up with the internet, and we understand how its algorithms work, which we can exploit to help market. If something is funny or shocking, people send it to their friends, and the algorithm picks it up and pushes it to others. Our understanding of this fact will allow us to market very successfully online.

Our youth may work to our advantage, but it also works against us. Given how young we are and how little capital we have, it would be hard to convince small businesses to take us seriously going forward, especially since we are focusing on social media. These small businesses do not even need to use us to market on social media. Granted, they will not understand how to use it as well as us, but they technically do not need us. Especially since we appear to be an unprofessional group, given that we have no office space or any clients, these early small clients can make or break Brand in a Box, depending on how our early days as a business go.

XVII. Final Business Model Canvas

Attach your updated BMC with the following color coding. Green highlight for items confirmed by interviews. Blue highlight for new insights added because of research. Red strikethrough for anything disconfirmed and removed. Every component should have at least one marking. If nothing changed in a component, note that briefly and explain why.

Key Partners	Key Activities	Value	Customer	Customer
Other	Creating	Propositions	Relationships	Segments
marketing	marketing	Marketing	Interaction with	Food Trucks
firms/ mentors	brand packages	Increased brand	business owners	Pop-up shops
Ourselves + our	Marketing our	awareness	Continuous	Gameday
peers	own service	leading to	communication	vendors
Food truck	Customized	increased sales	for approval	
owners	marketing for			

Student organization leaders Pop-up shops Stadium gameday food vendors	individual brands	Additional time for the owners Consistent media presence Consistency in the marketing shown on social media Improvement upon word-of- mouth marketing Engagement for customers, helping with repeat business	Transparency to uphold brand image Reliable / timely completion of projects Interpersonal interactions Data-driven transparency	
	Key Resources Photoshop editing software Experience Marketing courses through ISU for insights Editing hardware		Channels Socials: Facebook, Instagram, TikTok Sponsored results on web browsers, especially Google	

Business
knowledge –
regulation
compliance and
knowledge of
requirements

Word of mouth /
earned
marketing
Social Media

Cost Structure

Time of employees/ employee wages

Software charges involved with
editing/creating graphics or marketing

Hardware: desktops, our own laptops

Wear and tear/ maintenance on individual
hardware

Fixed Costs: Adobe Firefly at a cost of \$20
per month or \$240 per year

Main editing PC – Apple Mac Mini: \$600

Monitor: LG costing \$140

Keyboard costing \$50

Wear and tear on hardware, estimated at \$50
per year

Our own marketing costs per year - \$1920

Total fixed costs - \$3000

Revenue Streams

Initial charges to the business for the
package

Continued marketing charges for additional
work

Subscription-based packages

Potential for browser sponsorships, upcharge
for these

Unit cost: \$160 per month for 8 hours of labor at \$20 Office space per year (would only buy after a couple years of operation) - \$14,400 per year	
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Nothing changed in our BMC's key activities section. This is because we always planned on creating packages to help build a company's brand. We also learned that we needed more differentiated services to really cater to our customers, which falls under the umbrella of "customized marketing for individual brands".

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